
Introduction

The slogan “*communication is key*” is hopefully something you now understand to be highly relevant to transdisciplinary collaboration. But this is easier said than done. What should you consider when it comes to communication? At the heart of it lies the concept of a **shared language**.

The **theory page** and the **practice page** will help you explore this further.

Theory

For smooth communication, it is essential to have a mutual understanding of what your team intends to do. In other words, you need a shared vision, which in turn requires a shared language. To achieve this, you must gain insight into your own and each other’s backgrounds. While the use of certain terms may seem self-evident to you and your colleagues, people from other disciplines may interpret the same words very differently.

More theoretical insights on this topic will follow soon. Sign up for the newsletter to stay informed about content updates!

Practice

With exercises like the [Theory of Change](#), you can capture the diversity within a transdisciplinary team.

This exercise is used in co-creation processes to create a clear mission plan, align perspectives, uncover hidden misunderstandings, and analyze how long-term

goals can be achieved.

Truly understanding each other and developing a shared language requires **ongoing reflection**. That may sound heavy, but it essentially means never forgetting to ask questions about everything you say and hear. Do I understand this correctly? And: do others understand what I'm trying to communicate?

Feeling free and safe to speak up within the team is again essential in this regard. Only in this way can disciplinary boundaries be crossed and transdisciplinary knowledge emerge.